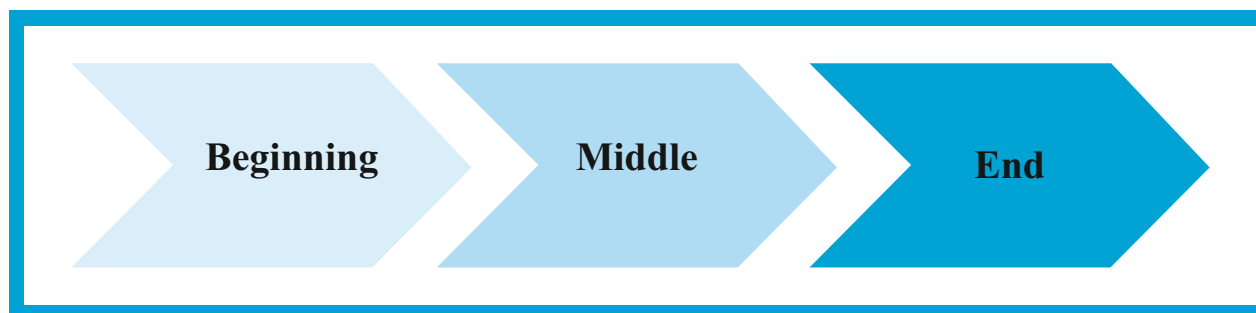


Chapter-6

Short Stories

Since times immemorial, stories have tempted people of all ages particularly the young children. A short story narrates an incident in the life of one or more characters. These characters may be real or imaginary. Stories are told both for entertainment and for developing moral values. There are several types of stories each with its peculiarities. Fairy tales, fables, bedtime stories, detective stories, thriller stories, historical stories, parables, are all types of stories with different themes, settings, styles, characters, style of narration, moral etc. However, there are certain elements which are common to all. All stories have a basic layout with a beginning, middle and an end.

Layout of a Story

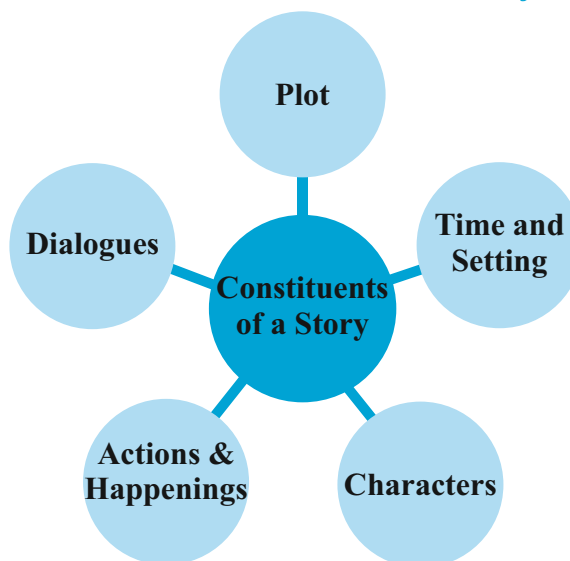


The Beginning: The beginning is the most important part of the story writing. It introduces all the major characters around which the plot of the story is wound. It sets up the time, background and action of the story. It should be so well written that it catches the reader's attraction. It highlights the people, places and situations in a creative way with a vivid description. It is the part where the writer can take his flights of imagination wherever he wishes keeping the plot in mind.

The Middle: The middle of the story develops the action. It introduces an element of conflict by creating situations where the characters of the story struggle to get a solution to their problem. It makes the readers curious to know what would happen next. All the major events and happenings of the plot happen in this part. The developments that take place in this part pave the way for the climax and the end of the story.

The End: The end marks the climax of the story and brings it to a close in an unexpected and interesting way. The end of the story may be either happy or tragic. Whatever be the type of story, it always conveys a message.

Constituents of a Story



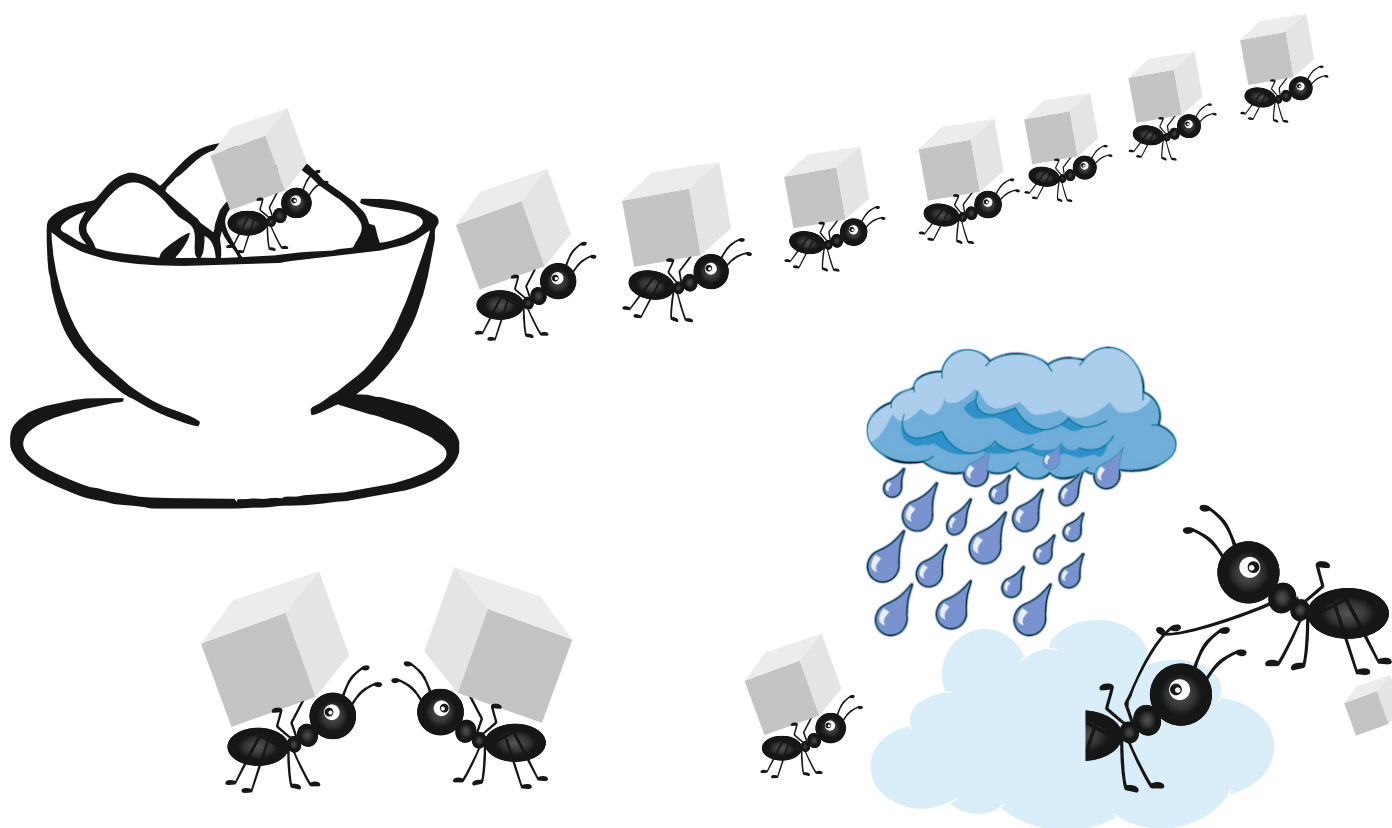
Important Points to Consider for Writing a Short Story

1. Choose a theme. Think of the characters and major actions.
2. Arrange the actions and events in a logical sequence and develop an outline.
3. Think of a suitable title.
4. Set the story in a certain time and space.
5. Write the beginning in an interesting and dramatic way by giving a vivid description of people, places and objects depending on the requirement of the story. Make sure that the description is not very long.
6. Use a variety of verbs in explaining the actions and happenings. Remember, a story is usually written in Past Tense, but the dialogues of the story may be in Present or Future Tense too. Use a variety of expressions and interjections to make the characters alive.
7. Use appropriate sequence markers (firstly, then, later on, soon, eventually etc.) and cohesive devices (but, so, however, thus, gradually etc.) to connect the actions.
8. Make use of appropriate adjectives and adverbs to create an everlasting effect about the characters and actions.
9. Use similes, metaphors, hyperboles and other figures of speech to beautify your language and narrate the story in a realistic way.
10. Make the end of the story interesting, dramatic and appropriate.
11. End your story with a moral or social message.

Ways of Developing a Story

1. Taking Hints from Visuals: A story may be developed taking hints from the visuals provided. The story must be related to the visuals provided.

Example:



2. Developing Story from the Beginning: In this method, only the beginning of the story is provided. The story developer is free to use his flight of imagination to develop a story and give it a suitable title.

Example: Once upon a time, there were two ants, George and John. George always worked hard whereas John was a shirker. One day.....

3. Developing a Story from the Outlines: A story may be developed from the given outlines which provide a clue about the plot of the story

Example:

A king-----had a lot of gold-----proud of gold-----still greedy for more gold-----hungry old man-----orders servant to feed the old man-----old man angel-----grants golden touch-----touches daughter-----daughter turns into gold statue-----repents-----requests angel to reverse the golden touch-----learnt a lesson-----gave away all his wealth.

The Midas Touch

Many centuries ago, there lived a king named Midas in **Greece**. The king had a **beautiful** kingdom. He owned so much gold that he could buy an entire city. His throne, his bed, his utensils were all made of gold. He loved his gold **dearly** and was proud of it. He had **innumerable** bricks and coins of gold which he kept safe in a dungeon. The king used to visit his dungeon everyday and count the bricks and coins of gold. The queen greatly disliked the king's obsession with gold. One day the queen said, **"O king, don't give so much value to gold all the time. Gold is not everything."** The king replied, "I can buy anything with gold. Now don't argue with me anymore."

The king's love for gold kept increasing each passing day. He loved it so much that he named his beloved daughter Marigold. Marigold was the dearest to her father. One day she called out to her father and said, **"Father, come and see how beautiful these flowers are. What a beautiful day it is!** Look how the dewdrops shine on the grass! "It is still not shinier than my gold", boasted the king. "You won't understand dear. You go and play alone." The little Marigold wondered how gold could be more beautiful than flowers.

As time passed by, King Midas started spending more and more time in the dungeon alone counting the gold bricks and coins over and over again. **A few days later**, the royal guards brought a strange, old man into the court of the king. **The man was dressed in simple clothes. He wore no sandals on his feet.** "Who is this man?" asked the King. "Your highness! I found him wandering in the streets. He says that he has lost his way and hasn't eaten anything for three days", said one of the guards. The king ordered his servants to make provisions for the old man's food and stay. **Suddenly**, the old man changed into an angel. He told King Midas that he was impressed with his greatness and wanted to grant him a wish.

The king, greedy for gold, asked the angel to give him more and more gold. The angel told that he could not give him gold, but he could give him a golden touch. The angel touched the king's hands and spelled a magic. He asked the king to touch a wooden stick. **As soon as** the king touched the wooden stick, it changed into gold. The king became **mad with happiness** to get the golden touch. He started touching things and changing everything into gold. **A little later**, he felt thirsty and ordered his servants to bring him a glass of water. As soon as the king held the glass of water, it changed into solid gold. The king tried to eat an orange and quench his thirst, the orange too changed into gold. The king was **dumbfounded**. He did not know what to do. **Before** he could understand anything, his little daughter ran into the court and jumped up into the king's arms. **No sooner** did the king catch hold of her daughter **than** she turned into a golden statue. The king started shouting and crying to see his daughter become a lifeless statue. He fell into the angel's feet and said, "I am **extremely** sorry for being so greedy. Please take your golden touch back and change and give me my daughter back." The angel took the golden touch back and wound a magic wand bringing Marigold to life again. **King Midas had learnt his lesson that gold could not buy everything. He gave away all his gold to the poor.**

Moral: Never be greedy.

This image shows a full page of a document template designed for handwritten notes or answers. It features approximately 28 evenly spaced, horizontal dashed lines across the entire width of the page, providing a guide for letter height and placement. The background is plain white, and there are no margins, headers, or footers visible.

2. Look at the flow chart given in the box below. Taking hints from the flow chart develop a story. Give your story a suitable title and write the moral of the story.



Rohan and Sumit----- friends----- crossing jungle-----see a bear-----bears don't climb up trees-----Rohan climbed up-----Sumit afraid-----lies quietly-----holds breath as if dead-----bear comes-----goes near Sumit, sniffs -----goes away-----Rohan climbs down-----Sumit silent-----Rohan asks what bear said-----Rohan said don't trust fake friends.....

This image shows a full page of white paper with horizontal dashed lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page, providing a guide for writing or drawing. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the page.

3. Look at the flow chart given in the box below. Taking hints from the flow chart develop a story. Give your story a suitable title and write the moral of the story.



Varun ----14 year old boy----bright and hardworking---- wants to become doctor-----meets an accident-----loses one hand-----depressed-----family supports him-----determined to pursue his dream-----works hard to achieve his goal-----hard work pays back-----becomes a celebrated surgeon-----proves----where there is a will there is a way

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

4. Given below is the beginning of a story. Use the beginning to develop a story and name it as ‘The Fox and the Crow’. Also write the moral of the story.

One day, a fox was wandering in a garden. He saw a crow swoop down and pick up a piece of cheese in its beak. Flapping its wings, the crow, flew onto a high branch of a tree and settled there to relish the piece of cheese.

[illegible]

5. Given below is the beginning of a story. Use the beginning to develop a story and give it a suitable title. Also write the moral of the story.

Once upon a time, there were two farmers. They were great friends. Ram lived in a village while Sham lived in a town. One day Ram gave his plough to Sham to mend it. But the dishonest friend Sham sold it and kept the money with him

[illegible]